

The Quake III game engine getting GPL'd was the best thing to happen to Linux gaming. Alien Arena and Warsow are two great Q3 based free games for Linux.

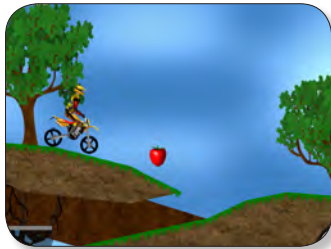
MOST ADDICTIVE LINUX GAMES

These are small games that takes under five minutes to download and install even on the most meagre internet connections. That does not stop them from excelling in gameplay

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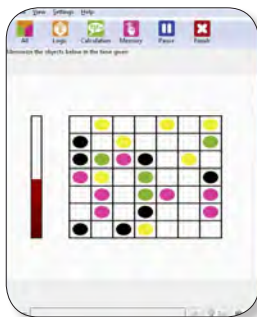
Xmoto

Xmoto is one of those few Linux games that manage to outshine the Windows counterparts. Xmoto is based on an old Windows game called Elastomania, both games involve guiding a motorcycle through a demanding set of obstacles. Xmoto comes with a lot of levels to begin with, and you will have to employ a wide range of tricks to cross any given level. At first, the graphics might look very stupid, the proportion of the biker to the bike is horribly wrong. That itself, is an aspect of the game-play, as you will quickly learn. The game looks deceptively simple, as controlling the bike on later levels gets increasingly difficult. Balancing the bike, flipping it around at the right time, and riding on the back wheel are elementary skills and there are plenty of surprises headed your way. Each level is also a puzzle, and you will be forced to use all the creativity you possess to cross it. Another element of game-play is beating the high score, which is the shortest time anyone has taken to cross the level. There are a whole range of maps that can be downloaded from the internet, and if you maintain a connection, you can compare your shortest times with other players around the world.



Gbrainy

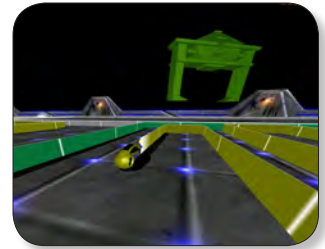
Gbrainy is a casual game, but don't expect to sit back and relax. Gbrainy pushes your brain to the limit, with a wide range of puzzles and problems that you have to solve. There are three types of game-play to choose from; logic, calculation and memory. When you choose one of these, a puzzle shows up, and you have to solve it. Within the framework, the puzzles are very ingenious. By far, the best game-play is offered by the memory games. A grid of twelve words will be thrown up, then will disappear after half a minute. Then a grid of eleven words will be thrown up, and your task is to identify the missing word. Directions will be given which you have to interpret, or a grid of colours that you have to memorise and replicate. You can also choose to play a mix of the three game modes, which will throw up a random puzzle each time. Once you are done, you can click on finish to get a score reading across the different game modes. This score includes the number of games played, the win/loss ratio, and the number of time taken for each game. The more you play, the smarter you get.



Gltron

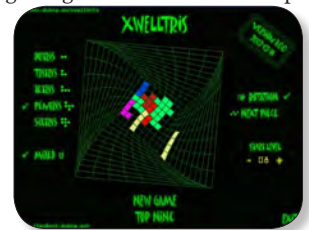
There are many tron games available, and a lot of them for Linux, as the sci-fi fan base is bound to use the OS. Gltron is one of the simpler

versions, which is nonetheless very addictive. The object of the game is to guide a lightcycle through a grid, while avoiding three other lightcycles. Each lightcycle leaves behind a trail, which becomes a wall, and which cannot be crossed. Your task is to outlast the other lightcycles, without hitting any of the light trails or the walls. At first, players will be focusing on staying alive instead of confusing the AI into crash into a wall. The game uses OpenGL to render the lightcycles and the trails, and the game itself looks like something a h4xx0r would have wet dreams over.



Xweltris

Imagine a cube of Tetris, without the top face. The bricks come down from the top face, the player has to guide the bricks along the walls and settle them on the floor. The game gives the illusion of dropping tetris bricks down a well. Traditionally, Tetris let you play a game with all possible combinations of four squares. This game, lets you go all the way till sixtris, and lets you play all possible combinations of anywhere from two to six bricks. Calculate the number of possible bricks. Now, your aim is to make rows along the bottom face. However, if you exceed the bottom space, the bricks leak onto one of the four walls, and the walls get locked. Wait, it gets more complicated. As you successfully make rows, you level up. Every time you level up, the well adds a layer, and then twists as it reaches the bottom. The more you level up, the more twisted the game gets.



Pingus

Pingus is a real time strategy games involving penguins that have to be guided through a level. Individual penguins (or pingus) can be given specific tasks to cross a particular obstacle. These actions include building bridges, jumping across short gaps, digging holes, bashing through walls, floating down from high places and exploding on a timer. The game has a storyline with twenty two levels that have to be crossed. Figuring out the best way to cross the level is the challenge, and the game periodically focuses you to think out of the box. Many levels force you to kill as many pingus as you save, and some levels can be crossed without losing a single pingu if you can think it out. In typical Linux fashion, at least seventy more levels are hidden away despite being packaged with the game. You will have to load them up from the filesystem. There is a level editor, and a lot of user made levels available on the internet. ■



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